DAY 15 OF 30

Mirroring

A live copy of your database in Fabric.
Without building a pipeline.

Near real time | Delta | No ETL

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THE PROBLEM

Analysts want live data. Databases want to be left alone.

1	**Query production directly**	The application slows down
2	**Nightly export**	Reports are a day old
3	**Build change capture**	Weeks of engineering

Every team ends up choosing between **fresh data and a healthy database**.

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THE SIMPLE VERSION

A mirror, not a photograph.

A photograph shows how things looked when you took it. A mirror shows how they look now.

Mirroring keeps a **continuously updated copy** of your database in OneLake, ready for analytics.

✓ **You do**	Pick the database and tables
✓ **Fabric does**	The copying, continuously
✓ **You get**	Delta tables, a few moments behind

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HOW IT WORKS

What happens behind the mirror

1. Fabric takes an **initial snapshot** of the tables
2. It then reads the **changes** as they happen
3. Changes land as **Delta tables** in OneLake
4. A **SQL analytics endpoint** lets you query them

Three kinds

Database mirroring copies data. Metadata mirroring links a catalog. Open mirroring lets any system push changes in.

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FOR ENGINEERS

The fine print that matters

Many sources now

Azure SQL, SQL Server, Cosmos DB, PostgreSQL, Snowflake, Oracle, SAP, BigQuery and Databricks catalogs, among others.

What is free

Replication compute is free. Storage is free up to 1 TB per capacity unit. Querying uses capacity as normal.

It is a replica, not a transformation

Tables arrive as they are in the source. Cleaning and modelling still happen downstream.

Read-only

You query the mirror. You do not write to it.

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THE HONEST PART

Mirror it or build a pipeline?

MIRROR

You need the tables as they are, kept fresh

The source is on the supported list

You want less code to maintain

PIPELINE

You only need a small filtered slice

The source is not supported

You must reshape data before it lands

> **The catch:** mirroring gives you a raw copy of an operational schema. Without a Silver layer on top, analysts inherit every quirk of the application database.

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WATCH OUT

Four checks before you mirror

1. **Unsupported tables or column types** in your source
2. **Network path**: can Fabric reach the database?
3. **Retention** of history on the mirrored tables
4. **Who models the data** after it lands

Mirroring replaces the ingestion pipeline, **not the modelling work**.

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SAVE THIS

Mirroring in five lines

1. **A live replica** of your database in OneLake
2. **No pipeline** to build or schedule
3. **Delta tables**, queryable with SQL
4. **Replication** is free, queries are not
5. **Model it** before people report on it

Tomorrow: Real-Time Intelligence. What "real time" actually means.

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